



## Christmas on the ISS

Astronauts complete a spacewalk on Christmas Eve to replace a damaged cooling unit on the ISS <http://dgit.in/Spacemas>



## Useless body parts

Yes, we humans have some useless body parts actually six of them. Curious? Check it out here: <http://dgit.in/UffBody>

Agent 001

## Budget laptop purchase

Dear Agent 001, I have read some of your articles on laptops. They are very informative. Now I request you to please suggest me a laptop in budget of ₹30,000.

Desired configuration is given below

- Intel Core i3 3rd Gen or AMD CPU
- 4GB RAM
- 500GB HDD minimum
- 1GB Graphics minimum
- 15.6 inch HD LED display
- Windows 8
- All connectivity ports
- HD webcam
- Least possible weight

Thanking you in advance. Please reply.

*Shashank Gosavi*

**A** Dear Reader, I recommend the following options.

1. HP Pavilion 15: <http://dgit.in/1eBFxLX>  
This machine has the AMD quad core APU, with 4GB RAM, 1GB graphics and a 500GB hard drive. Windows 8 comes preloaded.

2. Dell Inspiron 15: <http://dgit.in/1c2FfJR>  
In case you want an Intel Core i3 machine, this is a rather good option. Though you will compromise a bit in terms of the GPU - Intel HD 4000, and does not come with Windows 8 preloaded.

Unless you have something against AMD, I would suggest the AMD APU powered HP machine would be a better deal.



Budget laptops often have Linux as the OS

## Build a gaming rig

I need your advice on assembling a PC for playing high-end games such as "Assassin's Creed IV: Black Flag" & "Arkham Origins".

My budget for this is about ₹50,000/-, including all components, UPS, speakers & display monitor. If required I am prepared

to spend ₹60,000/- at the most. Your December 2013 issue has the specs for this, but is beyond my budget. I already have a licensed copy of Windows 8 & hence do not need to buy the OS.

Kindly advise if a gaming Laptop would serve the same purpose & if so, please



**A cheap UPS may do more harm than good**

additionally also recommend a good laptop within the same budget.

Best regards,

*Karan*

**A** Hey Karan, you can sacrifice processing power and go for a slightly less beefier processor and stick to a good graphics card. Getting all the components in a 50K budget is rather difficult but we can try and find one that is right for you.  
CPU - Intel Core i5 - 3470  
GPU - NVIDIA GTX 650Ti (Any brand)  
Motherboard - Gigabyte GA-B75M-D3H  
RAM - Any 8GB 1600MHz kit  
HDD - 1 TB

Cabinet - Get an OEM unit that supports ATX/mATX motherboards

Monitor - BenQ G2420 HD

UPS - None

SMPS - Seasonic S12II 620 Watts

Keyboard + Mice - Any combo under ₹600

Speakers - F&D 680

Skip the UPS for now and buy one later, it doesn't help if you go for a cheap UPS since they barely offer any backup or protection. This configuration should just about hit ₹60,000.

## Sharing 3G Internet with other Wi-Fi enabled devices

Agent 001, please help. I presently stay in Chennai and use a broadband service

provided by BSNL through a Wi-Fi router. Presently my laptop and two mobile phones are connected to the router whenever I am in range. In some more months I would move to some other place where BSNL broadband service is poor. So I am left with to choose from a couple of available 3G service providers. I have an unlocked 3G data card with me, too.

Is there any method by which I can share the 3G network to my Wi-Fi devices? I learnt a product named TP-LINK TL-MR3020 Portable 3G Wi-Fi router which costs about 1.4k can do this. Also I don't want to keep my laptop ON while the internet is being accessed on my mobile phones.

*Amit*

**A** Hey Amit! I'm guessing that between the two mobile phones you own at least one of them must be a smartphone. There is a feature called "tethering" which can be used to share the internet connection of your mobile phone with any device. If you are connected via USB cable to your computer then switch on USB tethering



**A portable router might be your solution**

and your 3G connection on the phone can be utilised by your computer. Similarly, you can pair your smartphone via bluetooth and leech the 3G connection as well. Since you haven't provided any details about your phones we can't comment further but certain manufacturers disable tethering on their Android phone and certain phones might require a software (PC Suite) to be installed on your computer aside from the drivers. The TP-LINK TL-MR3020 works in a similar fashion as well. However, if you receive any phone call while you are surfing the Internet then you may lose the Internet connection for the duration of that call.